Living in the Airport

Snowden would end up spending 40 days in the Sheremetyevo Airport's transit zone. During that time, one of his only connections with the outside world was his lawyer, Anatoly Kucherena. Several times a week, Kucherena would visit the small bare room where Snowden lived. Airport loudspeakers blared for hours on end and the air was stale. "If a person is there indefinitely it can drive him to psychosis," Kucherena told a reporter.[3] Nevertheless, he said Snowden remained healthy, even if anxious about his future.

Though technically a free man, Snowden could not leave the airport without a passport. Kucherena brought books for Snowden to read to help him understand the Russian people, including *Crime and Punishment* by Fyodor Dostoyevsky and Russian stories by Anton Chekhov. He also brought a book on the Russian alphabet to help Snowden start learning the Russian language. Because Snowden had arrived with almost no luggage, his lawyer brought him new shirts and a pair of shoes.

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